Read Words in Context

Vocabulary Words

bridge	**range**
bureau	**refrain**
cabinet	**rest**
contract	**rung**
harbor	**steer**
mold	**temper**
peer	**vent**
pelt	

Word Learning Tip!

Some words have two or more very different meanings. To determine what a word means in a particular sentence, you must find out its part of speech (is it a noun, verb, adjective, etc.?) and look for the meaning that the word must have for the sentence to make sense.

Vocabulary Building Strategy

Use Context Clues The only way to determine the meaning of multiple-meaning words is to study their context—the words, phrases, and sentences that surround them. Clues from the context help you determine which meaning of the word the writer intends.

READ!

Home on the Range



Carlos's parents have gotten **contracts** that permit them to raise cattle. These written agreements give them the right to graze their **steer** on public land. The cattle feed on the open **range**, acres of land that surround the family's ranch. Carlos helps with the work. As he herds the cattle, he often sings old cowboys songs. He repeats the same **refrain**: "And the skies are not cloudy all day."

Carlos knows that being a cowboy is hard work, but he likes it anyway. In the heat, an animal may get irritable and lose its **temper**. The cowboy must wait and watch until the steer calms down. In winter, the rain **pelts** down hard, striking both men and beasts. There is nothing to do but wait out the storm.

When Carlos and the other cowboys get tired, they **rest** under the trees. Often they have to brush some fuzzy green **mold** off the ground before they can lie down. No matter how glaring the sun, someone always has to stay awake to watch the herd, even if he has to **peer** at the cattle through half-closed eyes.

Back home at last, Carlos washes up for dinner. He takes fresh clothing from his **bureau**. This dresser holds all his clean shirts and pants. He takes a bottle of water from the kitchen **cabinet**, the cupboard next to the sink. Now, he can finally relax.

Sometimes Carlos gets a break from work and goes to the nearest port city. He likes to stroll on the **bridge** that spans the bay and watch the boats sail into the **harbor**. He also walks out on the docks where the boats tie up. When he can, he climbs down the **rungs** of the ladder on the side of the dock. He wants to see if he can get a better look at the boats. He is excited and **vents** his feelings by whistling softly to himself. But his thoughts stray back to home. The tune he whistles is "Home, Home on the Range."

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Connect Words and Meanings

bridge	**contract**	**peer**	**refrain**	**steer**
bureau	**harbor**	**pelt**	**rest**	**temper**
cabinet	**mold**	**range**	**rung**	**vent**

Directions Read the definitions for each word below. Then read the sentence that follows the definitions. In the blank, write the letter of the definition that best fits the context.

1. range
A. noun: an area of open land used for a special purpose
B. noun: a cooking stove
Carmella put the kettle on top of the **range**. _____

2. steer
A. noun: male cattle
B. verb: to move a vehicle in a certain direction
The pilot **steered** the ferry safely into port. _____

3. cabinet
A. noun: a piece of furniture with shelves and drawers; a cupboard
B. noun: a group of advisors for the head of government
The president asked his **cabinet** for advice. _____

4. refrain
A. noun: repeated words in a song or poem
B. verb: to stop yourself from doing something
The **refrain** from the poem kept echoing in his head. _____

5. vent
A. noun: an opening through which smoke or air can pass
B. verb: to show or let out
The gas escaped through the **vent** in the wall. _____

6. contract
A. noun: a legal agreement
B. verb: to get
The sick people were kept in a separate area so that others would not **contract** the disease from them. _____

7. bridge
A. noun: a structure built over a body of water so that people can cross it
B. noun: a card game for four players
C. verb: to connect
Fifteen thousand cars travel across the **bridge** each day. _____

8. mold
A. noun: a furry fungus that grows in damp places or on old food
B. verb: to model or shape something
Throw out that piece of bread because it is covered with **mold**. _____

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Connect More Words and Meanings

bridge	**contract**	**peer**	**refrain**	**steer**
bureau	**harbor**	**pelt**	**rest**	**temper**
cabinet	**mold**	**range**	**rung**	**vent**

Directions Continue the activity. Read the definitions for each word below. Then read the sentence that follows the definitions. In the blank, write the letter of the definition that best fits the context.

9. rest
A. noun: the others or the remaining part of something
B. verb: to relax or sleep
Who's going to eat the **rest** of this pizza? _____

10. rung
A. noun: one of the horizontal steps on a ladder
B. verb: made a clear sound; past participle of *ring*
The bell signaling the end of the school day had **rung** fifteen minutes earlier. _____

11. bureau
A. noun: a chest of drawers
B. noun: an office that provides information or another service
The clerk in the travel **bureau** got the airline tickets for our class trip. _____

12. pelt
A. noun: an animal skin with fur or hair still on it
B. verb: to strike or beat
The hail **pelted** her face as she walked through the storm. _____

13. temper
A. noun: a tendency to get angry
B. verb: to make things less harsh or difficult
The umpire had trouble controlling his **temper**. _____

14. peer
A. noun: a person of equal standing
B. verb: to take a careful look at something
The defendant was judged by a jury of her **peers**. _____

15. harbor
A. noun: a place where ships settle or unload their cargo
B. verb: to hide someone or to take care of someone
Although he knew it was wrong, he **harbored** the escaped criminal because he was his friend. _____

Make a Collage With a small group of classmates, make a word collage using one of the multiple-meaning words. Cut pictures from magazines or newspapers and write the multiple meanings of the word beneath each one. You may also want to illustrate one multiple-meaning word that is not on the list.

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Use Words in Context

bridge	**contract**	**peer**	**refrain**	**steer**
bureau	**harbor**	**pelt**	**rest**	**temper**
cabinet	**mold**	**range**	**rung**	**vent**

Directions Write a vocabulary word in each of the blanks in this passage. Look for clues in the context that will help you find the correct word.

Conversation With a Cowboy

I've been riding the **(1)** _____ for twenty-five years because I like wide open spaces. I **(2)** _____ from sitting around as much as I can. I prefer to keep moving. Oh, I **(3)** _____ when the sun goes down, but I get up mighty early. In the morning, I take it easy at first. A peaceful start to the day keeps me from losing my **(4)** _____ when upsetting things happen on the job.

The first thing I do when I get up is take my work clothes out of my **(5)** _____, an old cedar chest of drawers. Then I take some cat food from the **(6)** _____. I always keep it in an airtight cupboard so it stays fresh. I usually have to **(7)** _____ under the furniture to find my cat, Kitty, because she likes to hide in out-of-the-way places. I gently grab Kitty by her **(8)** _____, careful not to damage her fur. I pet her gently. People think cowboys spend all their time with **(9)** _____, but cattle are not the only animals we care for. I also like to **(10)** _____ stray animals and give them a good, safe home.

Write a Story Even cowboys have bad days! Write a bad-day story featuring a cowboy. Use at least five vocabulary words. Try to include context clues that will make the meaning of the vocabulary words clear. Circle each multiple-meaning word.

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Put Words Into Action

bridge	contract	peer	refrain	steer
bureau	harbor	pelt	rest	temper
cabinet	mold	range	rung	vent

Directions Complete each of the word maps below by filling in the blanks.

Meaning:

1. _____

2. _____

Part of speech:

3. _____

4. _____

bridge

How do you use it in a sentence?

5. Use first meaning: _____

6. Use second meaning: _____

Meaning:

7. _____

8. _____

Part of speech:

9. _____

10. _____

pelt

How do you use it in a sentence?

11. Use first meaning: _____

12. Use second meaning: _____

Make More Maps Working in groups, make word maps for five more of the vocabulary words. If some words have more than two meanings, add more blanks for these meanings. You may wish to use a glossary or dictionary to find all the meanings of a word.

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Review and Extend

bridge	**contract**	**peer**	**refrain**	**steer**
bureau	**harbor**	**pelt**	**rest**	**temper**
cabinet	**mold**	**range**	**rung**	**vent**

Learn More!

Sometimes the same word can be used as more than one part of speech. When you read, make sure you know the part of speech of the word. This will help you determine its meaning. Here are two meanings for the word *peer*:

The verb meaning is " to look": Even though she **peered** into the darkness, Christa couldn't make out the person walking toward her.

The noun meaning is "an equal": Hector and his cousin Miguel are **peers**. They are both eleven years old. Hector and his cousin Lena are not peers. She is fifteen years older than he is.

Notice that when *peer* is used as a verb it takes the verb ending *-ed* to show the past tense. When it is used as a noun, it takes the noun ending *-s* to show the plural.

Directions Read each sentence below. Use the context clue printed in boldface to decide which vocabulary word to write in the blank. The clue will also tell you whether to give it a noun ending or a verb ending.

1. The campers **got** poison ivy when they walked unprotected in the woods. Philip _____ it whenever he forgot to wear his gloves.

2. First, the clay was **shaped** by the motion of our hands. Then we _____ it into a vase.

3. The heavy rain was **beating** down on the roof. It _____ the tin like rocks!

4. The lawyer drew up the **legal documents**. The two _____ for the sale of the house had to be signed by both parties.

5. The guides **directed** us to the exit. They _____ us gently but firmly where they wanted us to go.

Write Interview Questions Write some questions that you would like to ask a cowboy or anyone else in a special field of work. Use at least three of the vocabulary words you did not use in the above activity. Circle each multiple-meaning word. Try to use three other multiple-meaning words, too.

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Check Your Mastery

Directions Choose the vocabulary word that best fits the context and write it in the blank. Use the boldface context clue to help you make the correct choice.

1. Trained sheep dogs **direct** the herds away from danger. The dogs _____ (*steer, cabinet, mold*) the sheep where the shepherd wants them to go.

2. The candidate was advised to **not take such a hard** stand on several issues. But she refused to _____ (*harbor, bridge, temper*) her speech, even if it meant losing votes.

3. The children need to **express** their anger over the rained-out ball game. After they _____ (*refrain, bridge, vent*) their feelings for a few minutes, they will find another activity that will make them happy once again.

4. If you **catch** a cold, cover your mouth when you sneeze! Other people can _____ (*steer, contract, bureau*) your cold if you sneeze on them!

5. The bakers **shape** dough into cookies. They _____ (*mold, peer, rung*) it into a variety of shapes.

Directions Circle the word that correctly fits in the blank for each analogy. Studying the relationship between the first pair of words will help you make the correct choice for the second pair.

6. **Stairway** is to **step** as **ladder** is to _____.
   rung **bridge** **harbor**

7. **Coat** is to **clothing** as _____ is to **furniture**.
   contract **vent** **cabinet**

8. **Harbor** is to **port** as **equal** is to _____.
   bureau **peer** **refrain**

9. **Person** is to **skin** as **animal** is to _____.
   steer **pelt** **mold**

10. **Bake** is to **oven** as **boil** is to _____
    temper **rest** **range**



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